Executive Summary



EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

KEY FINDINGS - PHASE 1A

Best Practices Study of Peer Districts

The consultant team researched over 10 districts with the following goals:

- Learn how peer organizations site, size, and design administration and maintenance and operations (M&O) facilities
- Highlight trends, exemplary practices, and lessons learned relevant to the District
- Inform potential adjustments to adjacencies and space and programming assumptions

The following six districts were chosen based on their size, urban context, and facility age or because they have recently modernized facilities. All six districts were interviewed and three were selected for tours. Interviews focused on a variety of topics, including facility siting, adjacencies, and space needs for administration and maintenance and operations functions. **Seattle was highlighted as the most similar to PPS based on number of students and schools**, San Francisco and Sacramento were also noted to be similar.

	PPS	SEATTLE	SAN FRANCISCO	SACRAMENTO	SALEM-KEIZER	BEAVERTON	EDMONDS
STUDENTS	44,000	49,000	49,000	41,000	39,000	38,000	21,000
SCHOOLS	81	104	132	75	65	56	34
TOURED		Y				Y	Y
ADMIN FACILITIES	JOINT ADMIN / M&O/ WAREHOUSE FACILITY	JOINT ADMIN / M&O/ WAREHOUSE FACILITY	2 MAIN ADMIN 8 ANCILLARY ADMIN	1	3	1	1
MAINTENANCE FACILITIES	2 ADMIN / WAREHOUSE FACILITY	2 ANCILLARY WAREHOUSES (PLANS TO CONSOLIDATE TO 1)	MAINTENANCE / WAREHOUSE CAMPUS	MAINTENANCE SITE	1 WAREHOUSE / MAINTENANCE CENTER	MAINTENANCE CAMPUS	MAINTENANCE / TRANSIT HQ
WAREHOUSE FACILITIES	1 TRANSPORT-ACTION FACILITY			1 HQ 1 CENTRAL KITCHEN / WAREHOUSE	1 IT FACILITY 1 NUTRITION SERVICES	2 TRANSPORTATION / WAREHOUSE	1
FACILITY DISTANCE	N/A	N/A	2.75 MILES MAIN ADMIN - M&O	5.25 MILES ADMIN - M&O	2.25 MILES ADMIN - M&O	1.6 MILES ADMIN - M&O	1 MILE ADMIN - M&O
				5 MILES M&O-WAREHOUSE	2 MILES M&O-NUTRITION	1.75 MILES M&O-WAREHOUSE	1 MILE M&O-WAREHOUSE
TOTAL EXISTING NET SF:	339,636	361,595					
OPERATIONS FACILITY NET SQUARE FOOTAGE							
	EXISTING SF / RECOMMENDED SF	EXISTING SF / IDEAL SF	EXISTING SF / IDEAL SF	EXISTING SF / IDEAL SF	EXISTING SF / IDEAL SF	EXISTING SF / IDEAL SF	EXISTING SF / IDEAL SF
MULTI-CRAFT SHOP	15,654 / 6,800	11,500 / 8,500	N/A	18,511 / 16,000	4,100 / 4,100	3,300 / 3,300	7,500 / 7,500
MECHANICAL SHOP[1]	16,993 / 10,625	18,852 / 5,200	N/A	6,653 / 8,000	10,000 / NOTED AS INADEQUATE	2,700 / 2,700	6,100 / 6,100
ELECTRICAL SHOP	12,526 / 2,975	4,000 / 3,000	N/A	3,611 / 1500		4,900 / 4,900	600 / 600
MUSIC SHOP	8,054 / 1,403	2,056 / 2,000[2]	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
WAREHOUSE	98,807 / 85,300	85,000 / 65,000[3]	112,000 / MORE NEEDED	70,000 / 70,000	26,000 / 60,000	27,800 / 27,800	9,600 / 23,000
NUTRITION SERVICES	25,296 / 22,768	29,000 / 23,000	OUTSOURCED	33,000 / 33,000	21,000 / 21,000	OUTSOURCED / NEED FOR CENTRAL KITCHEN	700 / CENTRAL KITCHEN IN EACH SCHOOL
PARKING	54,000 / 78,000	151,000 / 85,000	113,000 / 85,000	415,000 / 88,000	228,000 / 110,000	200,000 / 58,000	158,000 / 41,000
TOTAL EXISTING NET SF:	**177,330**	**150,408**					

[1] PPS - Mechanical Shop includes Plumbing, HVAC, Sheet Metal Shop, Machinist & Metal Shop. Seattle has reduced their Mechanical Shop as they are funded to replace mechanical units, boilers, etc. in lieu of fixing, They also do not include metal shop in the mechanical shop area.

[2] Seattle has reduced their required square footage for music shop by storing instruments at individual schools.

[3] Seattle does not store or compile science kits in their warehouse.

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Major Themes

Key findings from peer district interviews and site tours around location and number of facilities, administrative space standards, maintenance and operations spaces, and funding are summarized below.

Location and Facility Numbers

- In all but one district, co-location of administrative and operational functions was seen as ideal. If co-location was not possible due to space constraints, headquarters functions were often grouped in multiple locations.
- Multiple locations increase operating costs and impact communication and organizational cohesion.
- A central location is critical to operations, preferably with proximity to freeways for efficient district-wide access.
- Parking is a priority. All peer districts interviewed aside from San Francisco have ample, free parking for staff and visitors. Many are also close to transit.

Administrative Spaces

- Each staff is provided a workspace. None of the peer districts follow a shared workstation model, even when some remote or hybrid work is allowed.
- Space standards are beneficial. All peer districts saw benefit in standardization and intentional space planning to promote flexibility as departments grow or shrink in size and the workplace evolves.
- Enclosed meeting space is essential. Conference rooms and private phone rooms are critical for collaboration and virtual meetings.
- Open or flex space does not work. Open collaboration spaces were typically seen as disruptive or underutilized.

Maintenance and Operations Spaces

- The PPS food service central distribution model was viewed as ideal. Nutrition services space varies between a full-service central kitchen to outsourced food production and delivery.
- Peer district trades and warehouse space is smaller than at the District. Warehouse space depends on multiple factors, including storage system efficiency, inventory/surplus practices, and available storage in schools or other facilities.
- Dedicated shops are most common, though Salem-Keizer and Edmonds have shared shop spaces with dedicated storage.
- Shared shop designed to be flexible, depending on staff size and workload, is an exemplary practice.
- Music repair is outsourced in most districts, with the exception being Seattle.
- The approach to maintaining schools can influence headquarters shop size, as maintaining a variety of existing systems requires more storage than an approach that replaces all parts and systems with consistent selection.
- Peer district research indicates that other districts have smaller shops than PPS.

Funding

- Bond and/or levy funding is used by Seattle and Beaverton to support facilities operations.
- Bond staff are embedded with other operations, such as maintenance and real estate

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KEY FINDINGS - PHASE 1B

Summary of Project Scope

The objective of Phase 1b was to further refine the minimum square footage criteria needs for administrative office space and the operations/ warehouse spaces. This phase built upon the insights gathered during Phase 1a, including best practices and lessons learned from peer district tours and interviews. Additionally, previously completed reports were referenced to incorporate relevant information and avoid duplicative efforts.

A highlight of the scope of work completed by Bainbridge and Mackenzie are as follows:

- Conducted interviews with all Chief's and/or department representatives
- Verified existing office and storage space and identified other misc. needs
- Discussed operational impacts with each department should a future facility be split into two separate sites (Administration/Operations)
- Created programming sheet for each Chief/ Department identifying staff counts, types of workspaces, and required support spaces. A programming sheet was also created for the required shared spaces. (i.e. Board Room, Professional Development/Event spaces, Mother's Rooms, etc .). These sheets can be found in the Appendix of the full report draft.
- Identified satellite and hoteling spaces required by departments if split into two sites

Bainbridge and Mackenzie collaborated closely with PPS to develop targeted programming questions aimed at confirming departmental staff counts and identifying space needs based on key findings from Phase 1a. The consultant team were requested to work with the current staff counts, as of March 2025 (without increase or reduction). Future growth or any changes to current operations were not accounted for in the space and programming evaluation. These questions, along with data collected in Spring 2024 and a summary of the Phase 1a Focus Group meeting, were shared with each department Chief in advance of in-person meetings.

During these programming interviews, PPS and the consultant teams reviewed the programming questionnaires, gathered detailed information, and toured existing spaces to assess current conditions and uncover potential opportunities for improvement. A key focus of these discussions was understanding how a potential physical separation between administration and operations could impact departmental workflows and explore potential efficiencies. While off site departments and storage facilities were evaluated to establish an overall big picture, these spaces were excluded from the reccomended square footage.

The information gathered was compiled into a comprehensive programming spreadsheet that detailed each department's staff counts, workspace types (e.g., private offices vs. workstations), storage needs, and required support spaces necessary for efficient, high-quality operations. (See Appendix A) Standardized square footage allocations were applied to each space type to determine the total usable area required per department.

In parallel, PPS and the consultant team developed a programming sheet for shared spaces should the facilities be separated into two facilities (Operations and Administration), including the lobby, board room, conference rooms, and other supportive or code-required areas not assigned to specific departments.

These detailed programming sheets served as the foundation for creating three potential schemes/ scenarios to address the district's future real estate needs.

Summary of PEC Space and Programming Evaluation Report

The three schemes that were evaluated are the following:

Scheme 1 – A combined administration and operations facility, like the PEC with improved efficiencies.

Scheme 2 – Two separate facilities, one for Administration and one for Operations. The operations facility will be primarily shops, warehouse space, and nutritional services, and excludes administrative staff that have preference of being located at the operations facility.

Scheme 3 – Two separate facilities, one for Administration and one for Operations with each department located at their preferred facility. The following is a breakdown of departments at each facility:

- Administration Facility
  - Superintendent
  - Chief of Staff
  - Chief Financial Officer
  - General Counsel
  - Chief of Human Resources
  - Chief Accountability and Equity Officer
  - Chief Academic Officer
  - Chief of Student Success Services
  - Chief of Schools

- Operations Facility
  - Fabrication & Shop; Maintenance (COO)
  - Nutritional Service (COO)
  - Warehouse (COO)
  - Chief Operating Officer (COO)
    - Office of School Modernization (OSM)
    - Security Services
    - Real Estate & Construction (REC)
  - Office of Technology Information Services (OTIS)

	STAFF COUNT	CURRENT GROSS SF	MIN GROSS SF	PERCENT REDUCTION
SCHEME 1				
SINGLE SITE	691	339,636	278,557	18%
SCHEME 2				
ADMINISTRATION	577	115,218	113,544	1.5%
OPERATIONS CENTER	114	224,418	168,121	25%
TOTAL	691	339,636	281,665	17%
SCHEME 3				
ADMINISTRATION*	419	189,106	91,369	-2.5%
OPERATIONS CENTER	272	250,530	190,395	24%
TOTAL	691	339,636	281,764	17%

* Scheme 3 does not permit opportunities for sharing some of the large Administrative Support Spaces such as the Professional Development/Event and Large Conference Rooms accommodating 20-25+ people. Therefore these rooms have been allocated to Administration in lieu of Operations to eliminate duplication of spaces.

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The recommended range for each of the three different schemes to aid in a property search analysis are as follows. Please note that the range is rounded to the nearest thousand.

Scheme 1 –

- Combined Facility - 279,000 SF - 307,000 SF

Scheme 2 –

- Administration Facility with Operations Staff - 114,000 SF - 125,000 SF
- Operations Facility without Operations Staff - 168,000 SF - 186,000 SF

Scheme 3 –

- Administration Facility without Operations Staff - 96,000 SF - 106,000 SF
- Operation Facility with Operations Staff - 191,000 SF - 210,000 SF needs.

After completion of the programming schemes, Portland Public Schools preference is to remain in a similar model as the existing Prophet Center, Scheme 1, where all departments are co-located in one facility. With the understanding that a site/ property that can accommodate a unique program such as Portland Public Schools – Administration and Operational needs is limited. The second preferred scheme is Scheme 3, with select departments located at the Operations Facility.

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NEXT STEPS

The consultant team's recommendations for Portland Public Schools are as follows:

Identify Potential Sites/Properties for Purchase and Test Fit the preferred Scheme for the Site/Property.

- Once PPS has identified potential sites / properties that they feel meets the minimum criteria, it is encouraged that the District have the consultant team complete a test fit to ensure that all program elements identified in the PEC space and programming evaluation will fit within the space. Identify advantages and challenges to each potential site/property before making a final purchase.

Complete a cost estimate of each test fit completed

- Once the consultant team has provided a test fit conceptual design for each site/property a comprehensive cost estimate should be completed by a cost estimator. The cost should not only include the cost of the construction but also soft costs, which are inclusive of consultant fees for design services, surveys, permitting, furniture, fixture and equipment (FF&E), moving costs, etc.

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